AI Video Bootcamp

AI VIDEO BOOTCAMP

Ad Strategy Guide

Understanding Awareness Levels, Ad Objectives & When To Use What

AI Video Bootcamp

Before You Write a Single Script...

Let me be real with you. Most people fail with ads. Not because their product sucks, not because the platform is broken, and not because ads "don't work anymore." They fail because they run the wrong ad to the wrong person at the wrong time.

Think about it. You wouldn't walk up to a stranger on the street and ask them to buy your course. But that's exactly what most people do with their ads. They skip the intro, skip the context, and go straight for the sale. Then they wonder why nobody converts.

This guide breaks down the ONE concept that changed everything for me: customer awareness levels. It sounds fancy but it's dead simple. Where is your audience in their journey? Once you figure that out, picking the right ad type becomes obvious. You stop guessing. You stop wasting money. You start matching the right message to the right person.

I'm going to walk you through the five levels of awareness, the three types of ads you'll ever need, and exactly which frameworks from the Scriptwriting Playbook to use for each one. By the end of this guide, you'll never look at ads the same way again.

AI Video Bootcamp

The 5 Levels of Customer Awareness

This is the foundation everything else is built on



Level 1: UNAWARE

These people don't even know they have a problem. They're scrolling TikTok at 2am not thinking about your product at all. Your job here is to interrupt their scroll and make them realize something is off.

Level 2: PROBLEM AWARE

They feel the pain but have no clue what to do about it. They know their skin is bad, their energy is low, their business is stuck. But they haven't started looking for solutions yet. They just know something isn't right.

Level 3: SOLUTION AWARE

They know solutions exist. They've probably Googled it, watched a few videos, maybe tried a competitor. But they don't know about YOUR specific product yet. This is where most of your audience actually sits.

Level 4: PRODUCT AWARE

They know who you are. They've seen your ad, visited your site, maybe even added to cart. But something stopped them from buying. Price, timing, trust, whatever. They need a nudge.

Level 5: MOST AWARE

These people already know your product, probably love it, and just need the right offer at the right time. Past customers, email subscribers, engaged followers. Easiest people to convert.

AI Video Bootcamp

The 3 Ad Objectives

Every ad you ever run fits into one of these three buckets

1. AWARENESS ADS (Reaching New People)

Goal: Get in front of people who have never heard of you.

Think of this as casting a wide net. You're not trying to sell here. You're trying to stop the scroll, spark curiosity, and make someone think "wait, what was that?" These ads target Level 1 and Level 2 people.

What works:

- Entertainment and value first, product second
- Pattern interrupts (unexpected visuals, bold claims, curiosity hooks)
- Educational content that leads to your brand
- Story driven content that builds emotional connection
- Broad targeting, let the algorithm find your audience

What to measure: Views, reach, engagement rate, cost per 1000 impressions

Frameworks from the Scriptwriting Playbook that work best here:

THE SPARK (social proof momentum), THE MYTH KILLER (contrarian hooks), THE RAW TAKE (organic feel), THE EDUCATOR (value first), THE PRESSURE COOKER (pain agitation), THE CLIFFHANGER (curiosity loops)

2. CONVERTING ADS (Turning Interest Into Action)

Goal: Take someone who already knows about you (or their problem) and get them to buy.

This is the money maker. These ads target Level 2, 3, and 4 people. They already feel the pain or they already know your product exists. Your job is to close the deal.

What works:

- Clear product demonstrations
- Testimonials and social proof cascades
- Side by side comparisons
- Before and after transformations
- Strong CTAs with urgency or risk reversal (money back guarantees, free trials)
- Feature to benefit breakdowns

What to measure: Click through rate, cost per click, conversion rate, return on ad spend

Frameworks that work best here:

THE COUNTDOWN (listicle power), THE SHORTCUT (simplicity sells), THE WITNESS (testimonial cascade), THE DEMO DROP (product in action), THE TIME MACHINE (before/after), THE FACE-OFF (vs. comparisons), THE BRIDGE (goal/gap/gain)

3. RETARGETING ADS (Bringing People Back)

Goal: Re-engage people who already interacted with you but didn't buy.

These people visited your site, watched your video, added to cart, or engaged with a previous ad. They're warm. They just need one more push. This is usually where you get the cheapest conversions.

What works:

- Objection handling (address why they didn't buy)
- Social proof stacking (reviews, testimonials, user counts)
- Limited time offers and exclusive deals
- Behind the scenes and founder story content
- Reminder ads ("Still thinking about it?")
- UGC style "I almost didn't buy this" testimonials

What to measure: Return on ad spend, cost per acquisition, frequency (don't burn people out)

Frameworks that work best here:

THE CONVICTION (objection crushing), THE ORIGIN STORY (founder trust), THE WITNESS (social proof), THE GRIT AD (raw, authentic feel)

AI Video Bootcamp

Putting It All Together

The simple system

Here's how it works in practice. You run awareness ads to cold audiences to get them into your world. Some of those people click, watch, engage. Now they're warm. You retarget those warm people with converting ads. Some buy. Some don't. The ones who don't get retargeting ads.

It's a funnel, but don't overthink it. At its simplest:

Step 1: Run awareness ads to new people (use awareness frameworks)
Step 2: Retarget engaged viewers with conversion ads (use converting frameworks)
Step 3: Retarget site visitors and cart abandoners with retargeting ads (use retargeting frameworks)

The biggest mistake I see is people running conversion ads to cold audiences. You're asking someone to buy when they don't even know who you are yet. That's like proposing on the first date. Warm them up first.

Quick Match Reference

If your audience is... UNAWARE → Run awareness ads

If your audience is... PROBLEM AWARE → Run awareness or converting ads

If your audience is... SOLUTION AWARE → Run converting ads

If your audience is... PRODUCT AWARE → Run converting or retargeting ads

If your audience is... MOST AWARE → Run retargeting ads

AI Video Bootcamp

AI VIDEO BOOTCAMP

Ad Strategy Guide 2026

Built for creators who want ads that actually convert.